

# Ashentree Court

---

No. 111

THE HERITAGE *of* FLEET STREET

April 2026

---

Ashentree Court is a small historic alley off Whitefriars Street. On one side are information panels about the history of Northcliffe House, while steps on the other side lead down to the crypt of the former Whitefriars Monastery. At the end of the alley is Magpie Alley, where ceramic panels tell the story of Fleet Street and its famous newspaper industry.

The area reshaped during the early 1800s as Whitefriars Street was altered to create a more direct route to the River Thames. By the late 19th century, the district had become a centre for newspaper printing and publishing.

Northcliffe House was built between 1925 and 1927 as the purpose-built home of the Daily Mail printing presses. Designed by Ellis and Clarke, it was one of Fleet Street's most important newspaper buildings and was recognised for its innovative industrial design. Printing continued here until the late 1980s, and when the site was redeveloped. The historic façade was carefully preserved and remains today.